



Rules of Play

Version 1.10

Components	2	The Playing Field	8
About this Game	2	Overshooting the End Zone	8
Kickoffs.....	3	The Game Clock	9
Onside Kicks	4	Clock Management (Advanced)	9
Plays From Scrimmage.....	5	Advanced Rules.....	10
Red Zone Offense	5	Fumble Checks	10
Home Field Advantage.....	5	Fumbles on Sacks	10
Reading Play Results	5	Penalties.....	12
Breakaways	6	Special Plays.....	14
The Player Die	6	Replay Review	15
Turnovers.....	6	About the Play Cards.....	16
Interceptions.....	6	The Team Card	17
Fumble Recovery	6	Player Ratings.....	17
Punts	7	Solo Play.....	18
Pooch Punts	7	One Roll Resolution.....	18
Let It Roll	7	Optional Rules.....	19
Field Goal Attempts	8	Legal.....	20
Points After Touchdown	8	Index	21

Components

- A set of “Result Dice”: one six-sided die (“d6”) and two different-colored ten-sided dice (“d10s”)
- A twenty-sided “Player Die”



&



Result Dice

Player Die

- Offensive Play Card (2-sided)
- Defensive Play Card (2-sided)
- Kicking & Turnovers Card (2-sided)
- 2 Team Cards

Optional Components (Advanced Rules)

- Twenty-sided “Disruptor Die” (page 10)
- Advanced Rules Card (page 10)
- Ten-sided for assigning tackles (page 19)

Other Components

You will also need a way to keep track of:

1. Ball location on field
2. Down and distance
3. Game score
4. Time remaining in the game

Season Ticket Football includes scoresheets to track this information.

These files are available for free:

<https://seasonticketgames.com/products/stf>

3-D printed scoreboards are available here:

<https://3d6-gaming.store/>

About this Game

Season Ticket Football is a simulation of American professional football. We’ve worked hard to make the gameplay as fast and exciting as possible without sacrificing depth and realism.

These rules assume that you are already familiar with the rules of professional American football. (For example, you should know that a game starts with one team receiving the kick off, after which that team is given four “downs” to advance the ball ten or more yards downfield.)

For questions or feedback about these rules:

Facebook: “Season Ticket Football”

e-mail: cjd@sportsmogul.com

Playing Head-to-Head

- 1) Each team picks a play.
- 2) Offense announces which play they are running.
- 3) Defense reveals their play choice.

On punts and field goal attempts, the offense simply declares their play. No defensive play is needed.

Alternatively, you can print the Defensive Plays on two sheets and cut them to create 7 cards. Then the defense puts their chosen play face down before the offense reveals their play.

See page 18 for information on **Solo Play**.

Kickoffs

1. Roll the Result Dice and the Player Die. Read the d6 and white d10 to get a number from 10 to 69:

e.g.   = 41

2. Add the ‘Bonus to Kickoff Roll’ for the current year. (Rolls are not affected by the kicker’s ability.)

Bonus to Kickoff Roll (by season)

Before 1990	+0	2011-2014	+20
1990-1993	+10	2015-2024	+30
1994-2010	+0	2025 & later	+10

3. Look up the total on the following Kickoff table:

Roll + Bonus	Kick	Return
24 or less	Received at  	10 +  Yds
25-31	Received at 	Breakaway
32-56	Received at 	10 +  + KR Yds
57-59	Received at  – 5	Breakaway
60	Out Of Bounds	Ball placed at 40-yard line
61-69	Received  yards into end zone	10 + Breakaway (or Touchback)
70+	Touchback	Ball placed at 20-yard line*

The **Kick** column shows the result of the kick:

“Received”

Kick is caught by returner at the specified yardline:

1. Use the dice as rolled (do not re-roll) to determine the yardline.
2. Read dice shown next to each other (e.g.  ) as a two-digit number (e.g.   = 17).
3. Use Player Die to determine the Kick Returner.
4. Use the ‘Return’ column to calculate the length of the kickoff return.

“**KR** Yds” refers to the ‘Yds’ bonus listed for the Kick Returner. Add this to the kick return length on rolls from 30-46. (Do not add this to other returns.)

“Out of Bounds”

Place ball at the 40-yard line.

“Touchback”

Ball downed in end zone (or kicked out the back).

Season	Touchback Location
2015 and earlier	20-yard line
2016 - 2023	25-yard line
2024 and later	30-yard line

On rolls of 61-69, the receiver chooses between returning the kick or letting it go for a touchback. In solo play, teams normally take the touchback on kicks that are 5 or more yards into the end zone.

“Breakaway”

If any result shows “Breakaway”, determine the length of the Breakaway as follows:

1. Re-roll the 3 result dice and add them together.
2. Add the returner’s **Spd**.
3. Find the result on the Breakaway Table below.
4. Add Breakaway yards to any other yards listed for the result.

Breakaway + + + Spd

Total	Breakaway	Total	Breakaway
< 23	Use roll total*	28	50 + 
23-24	20 + 	29	70 + 
25	Touchdown	30	90 + 
26	30 + 	31+	Touchdown
27	40 + 		

* For roll totals below 23, yards gained equals the **roll total** (i.e. the three dice plus the player’s **Spd**).

For rolls where the blue die is added to the yardage, it is not necessary to re-roll this die before adding it.

When the **Spd** rating isn’t known (such as on a fumble recovery by the offensive line) use a **Spd** rating of 5.

Onside Kicks

Onside kicks are kept simple in *Season Ticket Football*. Roll the three result dice and add them together. Totals of 19 or higher mean the on-side kick succeeded (i.e. the kicking team recovered). Otherwise, the receiving team takes possession. The recovering team does not attempt to return the ball.

Add +2 to the roll for a surprise on-side kick. This is defined as any attempt before the 4th quarter. This bonus can only be used once per game.

Also add +2 for any attempt before the 2018 season. (Rule changes in 2018 significantly reduced the chance of a successful onside kick.)

Onside Kicks + + + Modifiers (below)

Total	Recovered By	Situation	Modifier
18 or less	Receiving Team	Before 2018	+2
19 or more	Kicking Team	Surprise On-Side	+2

Onside Kick Distance (yards) = 10 + 

An onside kick travels ten yards, plus the number shown on the blue die. Add this to the kickoff location (below) to find the yardline for the next play.

Kickoff Location (by season)

Before 1974	40-yard line	1994-2010	30-yard line
1974-1993	35-yard line	After 2011	35-yard line

Kickoff Distances

The Kickoff Table shows the yardline where the ball was caught. If you also wish to know the distance the ball was kicked, calculate it from the Kickoff Location table, above.

Kickoff Example

The 2019 Patriots are kicking off to the 2019 Chiefs. The kicking team rolls the Result Dice and the Player Die:



1. The **Bonus to Kickoff Roll** is “+30” for the 2019 season, increasing the roll from 27 to 57.
2. The total roll of ‘57’ shows that the kickoff was received 7 yards into the end zone and returned for “10 + Breakaway”. (The blue die is ignored for this result.)
3. The Player Die (8) indicates that the kick is returned by Mecole Hardman. The length of the return is 10 yards *plus the result of a Breakaway roll*.
4. For the breakaway, the receiving team rolls the Result Dice and adds them together.

 3 +  6 +  8 = 17

5. We add Hardman’s Spd (+9) for a **roll total** of 26. On the Breakaway Table, this is 30 yards plus the blue die (8) — for 38 total breakaway yards.
6. The breakaway yardage (38) is added to the 10 yards from the Kickoff result for a total return of 48 yards. With the ball received 7 yards into the end zone, the return brings the ball out to the Chiefs’ 41-yard line (48 – 7 = 40).

“Dynamic Kickoffs”

Starting in 2024, any kickoff that lands short of the 20-yard line is placed on the 40-yard line.

Plays From Scrimmage

1. Roll four dice (three Result Dice and the 20-sided Player Die):
2. Read the d6 and white d10 in order to create a number between 10 and 69:

e.g.   = 38

3. Look up this number on the play chosen by the offense. Most results show a position designation (e.g. “RB2”) and a player rating (e.g. “Rec.”).
4. Find the player rating on their team card and conduct a **Rating Check**:

Rating Check

If the blue die is less than or equal to the rating, use the 1st result listed. Otherwise, use the 2nd result.

A rating of ‘0’ succeeds if the blue die is zero.

A rating of ‘-’ always fails a rating check.

“Use Defensive Play Card”

Look up the same two-digit number on the play chosen by the defense, and determine the result as described in Step 4, above. (Do not re-roll.)

“Pressure”

The ‘**Pressure**’ result means the offensive line has failed to protect the quarterback. Re-roll the Result Dice and find the result on the ‘Pressure’ table.

Red Zone Offense

The defense’s job gets easier inside the Red Zone because there is less territory to cover. For all run or pass plays that start *inside the defense’s 20-yard line*, use the “Red Zone” result (if listed). *A play starting exactly on the 20-yard line is not in the red zone.*

Home Field Advantage

Home field advantage is reflected in rolls of ‘69’ on each Offensive Play. With the home team on offense, use the “Home” result; otherwise, use the “Away” result.

Neutral stadiums: For games in neutral stadiums, use the “Home” result for both teams.

Reading Play Results

Rushing yardage is shown in **red**. Yards gained equals the number shown. If the result includes an image of the blue ten-sided die, use that die in the calculation.

When adding the blue die, do not re-roll it. Use the number showing on the die.

Completed passes are in **purple** (with a light purple background). As with rush plays, add the blue die if specified.

Red for rushing yards; **purple** for passing yards.

Incomplete passes are shown as **INC**.

Interceptions (INT) include the number of yards from scrimmage the ball travels before being intercepted. Interceptions require a re-roll the Result Dice on the **Interception Return** table (see page 6).

Fumbles (FF) show the number of yards gained before the fumble. Fumbles require a re-roll of the Result Dice to determine which team recovers the ball (and if they are able to advance it after recovery).

Sacks (SK) show the yards lost on the play.

Penalties are shown on a yellow background:

FALSE START = Penalty against the offense. Move the ball back 5 yards and re-play the down (i.e. do not increment it).

PASS INTERFERENCE = Penalty against the defense. Move the ball forward the number of yards indicated and award a first down to the offense. If this would result in a touchdown, place the ball on the 1-yard line.

INTENTIONAL GROUNDING = Penalty against the offense. Move the ball back the number of yards indicated and increment the down. If this would place the ball on the goal line or in the end zone (or out the back of the end zone) the defense scores a safety.

Breakaways

Breakaways are indicated with '**BI**' or '**BI**'. To determine the number of breakaway yards added to the play, use the rules under Kickoffs (page 3).

Breakaways under Pressure

Breakaways on successful **Evade** checks are outlet passes to the receiver specified by the player die.
Breakaways on successful **Rush** checks are scrambles by the quarterback.

The Player Die

For many results, the players involved are obvious. On a 7-yard pass that succeeds because of **WR1**'s **Rec.** rating, we know that the **QB** completed a 7-yard pass to **WR1**.

Some results leave this open. If a rushing play checks the **Power** of the offensive line (**OL**), we still need to know the ball carrier. This is where the twenty-sided "Player Die" comes in.

For Rushes and Catches, look down the relevant column ('Rush' or 'Catch') to find the ball carrier or receiver. (For completions on Medium and Long passes, use the 'Catch+' column.)

For Sacks and Interceptions, use the 'INT' and 'Sack' columns.

If the listed player isn't in the game (e.g. a backup quarterback) re-roll the Player Die.

Turnovers

Interceptions

On interceptions triggered by a defender's **Int** rating, that player records the interception. For all other interceptions, use the Player Die and the 'Int' column to determine which defender completes the interception.

Then, re-roll the result dice on the **Interception Return** table to determine the length of the interception return (if any):

Interception Return &

 	Return Length (Yards)
10-27	No Return (0)
28-29	 - 5 yds
30-39	 + 1 yd
40+	Breakaway

Fumble Recovery

Re-roll the Result Dice.

1. Read the red and white dice as a 2-digit number.
2. For fumbles on rush or pass plays of ten or more yards, add 30 to this roll.
3. Find the team and player that recovered the fumble:

Fumble Recovery &

 	Player	 	Player	 	Player
10-11	QB	40-42	S1	65-66	TE1
12-14	RB1	43-44	LB1	67	TE2
15-17	RB2	45-46	LB2	68-71	CB1
18	RB3	47-48	LB3	72-79	CB2
19-26	OL	49-50	LB4	80-87	S2
27-29	DL1	51	LB	88-89	DB
30-32	DL2	52-59	Out Of Bounds	90-92	WR1
33-35	DL3			93-95	WR2
36-38	DL4	60-64	Ball Carrier	96-98	WR3
39	DL			99	WR4

Rush/Pass of 10+ Yards: Add 30 to above roll

4. Use the blue die to determine whether the recovering player is able to return the ball:

Fumble Return?

	Recovered By Offense	Recovered By Defense
0-6	No	No
7-8	No	Yes
9	Yes	Yes

Yes = Roll on **Interception Return** (right)

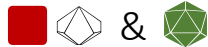
If the blue die indicates that the player returns the ball, roll the result dice again on the **Interception Return** table above.

Punts

The Punt Table shows the length of the punt (from the line of scrimmage) before any adjustment. *The blue die is not used for this table.*

Add the punter's Dist to the length of the punt. Do this even if this causes a touchback — sometimes too much distance is a bad thing.

Punts



	Distance		Distance
10	25 (OOB)	46-49	43 (Caught)
11	28 (FC)	50-51	44 (FC)
12-13	30 (Caught)	52	45 (Downed)
14-15	31 (OOB)	53-55	46 (Caught)
16-18	33 (Caught)	56	47 (OOB)
19	34 (Downed)	57-59	48 (Caught)
20-24	35 (Caught)	60	49 (Downed)
25-26	36 (FC)	61-62	50 (Caught)
27-29	37 (Caught)	63	51 (FC)
30-31	38 (OOB)	64-65	53 (Caught)
32-37	39 (Caught)	66	55 (Caught)
38-39	40 (FC)	67	58 (Caught)
40-44	41 (Caught)	68	60 (Downed)
45	42 (Downed)	69	65 (Caught)

(OOB = Out of Bounds) (FC = Fair Catch)

OOB, FC, & Downed: Receiving team takes possession at the specified location. A touchback results if this location is on or past the 0-yard line.

Caught: The punt is caught in the field of play and returned using the rules for Punt Returns (below).

Punt Returns

Any "Caught" punt is returned by the receiver specified by the Player Die. Roll the result dice again to determine the return length:

	Return		Return
10-12	- 4	40-59	+ PR 'Yds'
13-39	+ 0	60+	Breakaway

Don't re-roll the Player Die on punt returns — the returner is determined on the original punt roll.

Pooch Punts

Inside opponent territory, some punters may switch from a normal punt to a "pooch punt": a punt that emphasizes hang time and placement over distance.

The line of scrimmage must be within the distance noted in the punter's "Pooch" section.

Instead of showing the length of the punt, the Pooch Punt Table shows the yardline where the ball lands or is caught. Compare the blue die to the punter's Pooch rating to determine which column to use.

Designer's Note: Pooch Punts

"Pooch punt" refers to a technique used extensively in the 1960s and 1970s. Modern punters don't use the "pooch" kick per se, instead relying on hang time and athletic coverage teams. Nevertheless, we have kept the term "pooch punt" to describe the strategy of trying to pin the receiving team near their own goal line.

Let It Roll

On "Caught" and "Fair Catch" results near the end zone, the receiver may let the ball land, hoping that it will bounce and roll into the end zone.

To calculate the distance of the bounce:

- Roll all 3 dice (red, white and blue).
- Add the two ten-sided dice (blue & white).
- Subtract the six-sided die.

Add bounce to punt distance (or subtract if result is negative). If ball is in field of play after the bounce, it is downed by punting team at that spot. If it goes into or through the end zone, the result is a touchback.

Solo play: The receiving team will "let it roll" for...

Fair Catches within 8 yards of the end zone.
Returnable catches within 5 yards of the end zone.

Playing the Odds

The average bounce results in 4-7 additional yards.
There is a 9% chance the bounce will go backwards.

Field Goal Attempts

1. Determine the distance of the field goal attempt by adding 17 to the current yard line (before 1974, add 7 yards instead of 17).
2. Find the distance on the table below to get the roll needed (after bonus) for a successful kick.

Field Goals

 +  +  + Bonus Kicker

Distance	Roll	Distance	Roll
1-19 yds	9+	56-57 yds	20+
20-22 yds	10+	58-59 yds	21+
23-25	11+	60-61 yds	22+
26-29	12+	62-63 yds	23+
30-34	13+	64 yds	24+
35-39	14+	65 yds	25+
40-43 yds	15+	66 yds	26+
44-46 yds	16+	67 yds	27+
47-49	17+	68 yds	28+
50-52 yds	18+	69 yds	29+
53-55 yds	19+	70 yds	30+

3. Find the kicker's bonus matching the length of the kick (<30, 30-39, 40-49 or 50+).
4. Roll the Result Dice and add them together to generate a number between 1 and 24.
5. Add the kicker bonus. **If this equals or exceeds the needed roll, the kick is good.**
6. A roll (after bonus) of 8 or less always misses.
7. Attempts of more than 70 yards always miss.

Points After Touchdown

Treat points after touchdown (PATs) as field goal attempts:

- Before the 1974 season, PATs are 9 yards.
- From 1974 through 2014, PATs are 19 yards.
- Starting in 2015, PATs are 32 yards.

	FG Distance	Extra Point	Roll
2015 - Present	Add 17 yds	32 yds	(13+)
1974 - 2014	Add 17 yds	19 yds	(9+)
1933 - 1973	Add 7 yds	9 yds	(9+)

Field Goal and Extra Point Distances

Missed Field Goals

The defense takes possession after a missed field goal. The yardline depends on the season being played:

Season	Next Possession Starts at...
Before 1974	20-yard line
1974 - 1993	Previous line of scrimmage*
1994 and later	Spot of the kick (previous line of scrimmage minus 7 yards)*

**If this would place the ball inside the 20-yard line, spot the ball at the 20-yard line.*

Safeties

A safety results from any play that ends in the offense's end zone or would go out the back of the end zone.

A safety scores two points for the defensive team. The team that was scored upon must then perform a "free kick" from their own 20-yard line:

- 1) Conduct the free kick using the Punts Table, adding 10 yards to the punt distance.
- 2) Select a Punt Returner using the Player Die.
- 3) On the Punts Table, treat all rolls other than '10' as "Caught" and roll for a Punt Return.
- 4) Add 20 to the Punt Return roll.

The Playing Field

Each end zone starts at the "zero" yardline and extends for nine more yards.

Overshooting the End Zone

On Medium and Long passes, it is possible for the ball to be caught past the back of the end zone. If a completed pass or interception (or pass interference penalty) exceeds the current yardline by 10 or more yards, change the result to an incomplete pass.

This rule applies to distances stated explicitly on the Play Cards; it does not apply to **breakaway** yardage.

This rule cannot create an incompletion on a failed Tackle check (i.e. a defender's failure to tackle a receiver means the ball was caught and advanced after the catch).

The Game Clock

In the **Basic Game**:

- All plays take 30 seconds off the clock.¹
- Plays in the last 2 minutes of either half only take 10 seconds off the clock.

*The above assumes each team is using timeouts intelligently. **There is no need to track timeouts.***

Basic Game Play-By-Play Sheet

Alternatively, you can write each play result on the “Basic Game Play-By-Play Sheet” to track the game clock. This sheet lists 155 plays per game, eliminating the need to calculate elapsed time for each play. The time remaining before each play is pre-marked, with smaller increments near the end of each half to reflect the fact that teams are calling timeouts and/or using a hurry-up offense.

Clock Management (Advanced)

In the advanced game:

- All plays use 5 seconds of clock.¹
- If the clock isn’t stopped, an additional 30 seconds elapses between plays.¹

Each row on the “Game Clock” sheet equals 30 seconds. Move a marker right 1 space for each play (5 seconds) and down 1 row after each play (30 seconds).

The clock is stopped:

- After an incomplete pass.
- After a score or touchback.
- After a change of possession.
- At the end of a quarter.
- At the 2-minute warning.
- When either team calls a timeout.

In the above situations, the clock starts at the beginning of the next play, meaning that the 30-second gap between plays is completely eliminated.

¹ With 3 exceptions that use no clock time: extra points; 2-point conversions; kickoffs that result in a touchback.

Hurry-Up Offense

In the last two minutes of the first half or the last five minutes of the second half:

1. **The offense may run a “hurry-up offense”**, causing the clock to elapse 20 seconds between plays instead of 30 seconds.
2. **The clock stops after a penalty** (even if the penalty is declined).
3. **The clock stops if the play ends out of bounds.** The offense may go out of bounds on any play result marked with a dot.² All other plays end in-bounds.

Short Pass creates the best chance of a completed pass that lets the receiver get out of bounds. **Medium Pass** and **Long Pass** are more likely to be completed to the middle of the field.

Finally, the offense may stop the clock at any time by spiking the ball. This takes 10 seconds off the clock (9 seconds to get set and 1 second to spike the ball). It counts as an incomplete pass (charged to the team but not to the quarterback).

The clock does not stop if the offense fumbles the ball out of bounds.

“Milking the Clock”

Conversely, the offense can also try to maximize the time elapsed between plays. Increase the time between plays from 30 seconds to 35 seconds if the offense is trying to run out the clock.

The offense may also choose a “Kneel Down” play that results in a 1-yard loss without any chance of a fumble. (As with spiking the ball, the team — not the QB — is charged with a negative rushing play.)

² On Sack results (**SK**) that go out of bounds, the QB runs out (or is forced out) behind the line of scrimmage.

Advanced Rules

The Advanced Game adds a 20-sided die called “The Disruptor Die”:



Fumble Checks

A **fumble check** is triggered when the Disruptor Die rolls a ‘1’. **Re-roll the Disruptor Die**. A fumble occurs if the new roll is less than or equal to the ball carrier’s **Fum** rating. (A **Fum** rating of ‘-’ means no fumble is possible.)

On completed passes, the receiver is the ball carrier.

Fumbles on Sacks

A sack causes a fumble if the Disruptor Die is less than or equal to the quarterback’s **Fum** rating.

After a fumble, roll the 3 result dice and check the *Fumble Recovery* table. The red & white dice determine who recovers; the blue die specifies whether the ball is returned.

Result of Fumble Checks by Play Type

On a **rushing play, completed pass, or sack**: the fumble occurs at the yard line where the play ended.

On **punt returns, kick returns, interception returns** and **fumble returns**: fumbles occur at end of the run.

On **fair catches**, the fumble by the punt returner occurs at the location of the catch.

There is no need to conduct a fumble check for:

- **Incomplete passes** or **interceptions**
- Punts or kickoffs that result in a **touchback**
- **Forced fumble** results (**FF**)

Fumbles Checks on Penalties

If you roll a ‘1’ on the Disruptor Die and the Play Card shows a “False Start” penalty, this is a fumble check *during the snap*. Re-roll the Fumble Die and check the result against the QB’s **Fum** rating. If a fumble occurs, the ball is recovered on or behind the line of scrimmage (a number of yards equal to the blue die).

If no fumble occurs, the play results in a False Start penalty as shown on the Play Card.

Fumbles Checks on Touchdowns

Ignore any fumble check that occurs on a touchdown. (*The touchdown was scored before the ball was fumbled.*)

Fumbles Checks on Punts (Blocked Punts)

Each punter has a **Blk** rating that functions in the same way as a ball carrier’s **Fum** rating. On a roll of 1 on the Disruptor Die, re-roll the die; if it is less than or equal to the **Blk** rating, the punt is blocked.

Fumbles Checks on Field Goals (Blocked Kicks)

A “fumble check” on a Field Goal Attempt creates the chance of a *blocked kick*. Use the FG Distance and current season to find the Field Goal Block Chance:

Season	<20	20-29	30-39	40-49	50-59	60+
1960 - 1979	5	10	15	20	20	20
1980 - Present	1	4	8	10	12	20

Re-roll the Disruptor Die; if it is less than or equal to the Block Chance, the kick is blocked and lands behind the line of scrimmage (add 5 to the blue die to determine the location). *Use the Fumble Recovery table to determine which team recovers the blocked kick* (and if they return it).

Fumble Recovery on Special Teams Plays

The Fumble Recovery table (page 6) specifies the player that recovers a fumble on a play from scrimmage (when the starting offense and defense are on the field).

For special teams plays:

1. Use the same Fumble Recovery table for all fumbles, blocked kicks or blocked punts.
2. The blue (offensive) results refer to the team that possessed the ball before the fumble or block.
3. Use your own judgment to decide if the specified player is on the field for the play. If in doubt, assume the ball is recovered by a special teams player that is not listed on the team card.
4. For any returns, use the Speed of the specified player, *even if this player isn’t currently on the field*.

When to Roll the Disruptor Die

The Disruptor Die is rolled with the Result Dice at the beginning of each play.

On a result that requires an additional roll (i.e. a breakaway or 'Pressure' roll), **keep the Disruptor roll and re-roll just the three result dice**. Once the final result of the play is determined, apply the result of the Disruptor Die to that result.

Fumbles & Interceptions

Re-roll the Disruptor Die when you roll on the **Fumble/INT Return** table. If a fumble or interception is *not returned*, do not re-roll the Disruptor Die.

If the Disruptor Die shows a '1' on any fumble or interception return, the fumble is automatic — there is no need to check the 'Fum' rating or re-roll the Disruptor Die.

Advanced Rules



Fumble Check



Penalty

Optional Rules ("Super-Advanced")



Replay Review
(benefitting *offense*)



Replay Review
(benefitting *defense*)

Declining Penalties

The team receiving the benefit of the penalty may choose to decline the penalty and accept the result of the play instead.

Penalties

A roll of '20' on the Disruptor Die indicates a flag on the play. **Re-roll the Disruptor Die** and look down the 'Rush' or 'Pass' column below to find the result:

Rush	Pass	Result (Penalty Yards)
-	1	Ineligible Downfield Pass (OFF 5)*
-	2	Offensive Pass Interference (OFF 10)
1-8	3-9	Offensive Holding (OFF 10)
9	-	Illegal Block Above Waist (OFF 10)
10	10	Illegal Formation (OFF 5)
11	11	Neutral Zone Infraction (DEF 5)
12	12	Too Many Men on Field (DEF 5)
13-15	13	Defensive Offsides (DEF 5)
16	14	<i>Illegal Use of the Hands (DEF 5)</i>
17	15-16	<i>Defensive Holding (DEF 5)</i>
-	17-18	<i>Roughing the Passer (DEF 15)</i>
18-19	19	<i>Unnecessary Roughness (DEF 15)</i>
20	20	<i>Face Mask (DEF 15)</i>

* *Ineligible Downfield Pass* also causes loss of down.

On penalties shown in *red italics*, the offense also receives an automatic first down. If a *(DEF 15)* penalty occurs on a gain by the offense, the penalty yards are added to the end of the play.

Penalties on Kickoffs

'OFF' = penalty against the kicking team.

'DEF' = penalty against the receiving team.

Kickoff	Result (Penalty Yards)
1	Illegal Formation (OFF 5)
2	Offside on Free Kick (OFF 5)
3	Holding (OFF 10) [by Kicking Team]
4	Horse Collar Tackle (OFF 15)
5	Face Mask (OFF 15)
6	Unnecessary Roughness (OFF 15)
7-18	Holding (DEF 10) [by Receiving Team]
19	Illegal Double-Team Block (DEF 10)
20	Unnecessary Roughness (DEF 15)

Penalties shown in **bold** only occur on kick returns. If kickoff was not returned, no penalty occurs.

See next page ("Penalties on Returns") to determine where penalties on kickoffs are assessed.

For onside kicks, ignore all rolls of 10 or higher on the above table (i.e. no penalty occurs).

Penalties on Punts

'OFF' = penalty against punting team

'DEF' = penalty against receiving team

Punt	Result (Penalty Yards)
1	False Start (OFF 5)
2-3	Illegal Formation (OFF 5)
4-8	Kick Catch Interference (OFF 15)
9-10	Player Out of Bounds (OFF 5)
11-17	Defensive Offsides (DEF 5)
18	Illegal Formation (DEF 5)
19	Running into the Kicker (DEF 5)
20	<i>Roughing the Kicker (DEF 15)</i>

On *Roughing the Kicker*, the punting team also receives an automatic first down.

Penalties on Punt Returns

'OFF' = return team / 'DEF' = punting team

Roll	Result (Penalty Yards)
1-7	Holding (OFF 10)
8	Illegal Use of Hands (OFF 10)
9	Illegal Blindside Block (OFF 15)
10	Illegal Block Above Waist (OFF 15)
11-12	Horse Collar Tackle (DEF 15)
13-15	Face Mask (DEF 15)
16-18	Unnecessary Roughness (DEF 15)
19	Unsportmanlike Conduct (DEF 15)
20	Taunting (DEF 15)

Penalties on Field Goal Attempts

	Result (Penalty Yards)
1	False Start (OFF 5)
2	Offensive Holding (OFF 10)
3	Unsportsmanlike Conduct (OFF 15)
4-13	Defensive Offsides (DEF 5)
14	Illegal Formation (DEF 5)
15	Running into the Kicker (DEF 5)
16	<i>Defensive Holding (DEF 5)</i>
17	<i>Roughing the Kicker (DEF 15)</i>
18	<i>Leverage (DEF 15)</i>
19	<i>Leaping (DEF 15)</i>
20	<i>Unnecessary Roughness (DEF 15)</i>

On penalties shown in *red italics*, the offense also receives an automatic first down.

Penalties on Fumble and Interception Returns

'OFF' = penalty against returning team

Result (Penalty Yards)

1-10	Holding (OFF 10) [by Returning Team]
11	Unnecessary Roughness (OFF 15)
12	Illegal Block Above Waist (OFF 15)
13	Illegal Double-Team Block (OFF 10)
14-15	Horse Collar Tackle (DEF 15)
16-17	Face Mask (DEF 15)
18	Unsportsmanlike Conduct (DEF 15)
19-20	Unnecessary Roughness (DEF 15)

Penalties are assessed from the end of the return.

Penalties on Returns (Kicks/Punts/Ints/Fumbles)

Penalties against the returner's team occur at the halfway point of the return (round down any fraction). Assess the penalty from this spot.

Penalties in favor of the returner are added to the end of the return.

Penalties on the Last Play of the Half

The half cannot end on a penalty by the defense. A defensive penalty on the last play of a half entitles the offense to run one additional play after the clock expires.

Historically Accurate Penalties (Optional)

These penalty tables reflect the modern rulebook. For historical seasons, you can change anachronistic results to penalties that existed in the season being replayed:

<i>Penalty Rolled</i>	<i>Adjustment</i>
<i>Horse Collar Tackle</i>	Before 2005, change to <i>Unnecessary Roughness</i>
<i>Illegal Blindside Block</i>	Before 2019, change to <i>Clipping</i>
<i>Illegal Double-Team Block</i>	Before 2009, change to <i>Holding</i>
<i>Leaping</i>	Before 2017, change to <i>Unnecessary Roughness</i>
<i>Leverage</i>	Before 2010, change to <i>Roughing the Kicker</i>

None of the above adjustments change the team penalized or the number of yards assessed.

Penalties Near the End Zone

Football rules specify that a penalty cannot move the ball more than half the distance toward the nearest end zone. This table shows the number of yards to award on penalties near the end zone:

Yardline	5-yard Penalty	10-yard Penalty	15-yard Penalty
29	5	10	14
28	5	10	14
27	5	10	13
26	5	10	13
25	5	10	12
24	5	10	12
23	5	10	11
22	5	10	11
21	5	10	10
20	5	10	10
19	5	9	9
18	5	9	9
17	5	8	8
16	5	8	8
15	5	7	7
14	5	7	7
13	5	6	6
12	5	6	6
11	5	5	5
10	5	5	5
9	4	4	4
8	4	4	4
7	3	3	3
6	3	3	3
5	2	2	2
4	2	2	2
3	1	1	1
2	1	1	1
1	0	0	0

Pass Interference and Intentional Grounding

Pass Interference and Intentional Grounding are both "spot fouls" meaning that they are not affected by the rule limiting penalties to "half the distance".

If Pass Interference would result in a touchdown, place the ball on the 1-yard line.

If an Intentional Grounding call would place the ball on or behind the goal line, the result is safety.

Penalties on Touchdowns

If a (*DEF 15*) penalty occurs on an offensive touchdown, enforce the penalty on the point-after attempt (i.e. place the ball at the 1-yard line for a 2-point attempt).

Special Plays

If the offense is within 50 yards of the end zone, they may attempt a Hail Mary pass. Ignore the defensive play call and roll on the following table:

Hail Mary

Roll	Player	Rating	🔹 ≤ Rtg	🔹 > Rtg
10	FALSE START (OFF 5)			
11	PASS INTERFERENCE (END ZONE)			
12-14	QB	Deep	TD**	INC.
15-17	WR1	Deep	TD	INC.
18-19	WR2	Deep	TD	INC.
20-21	WR3	Deep	TD	INC.
22	WR4	Deep.	TD	INC.
23-24	CB1	Cover	INC.	TD**
25-26	CB2	Cover	INC.	TD**
27	S1	Cover	INC.	TD**
28	S2	Cover	INC.	TD**
29-32	CB1	Int	INT (EZ)	INC.
33-36	CB2	Int	INT (EZ)	INC.
37-39	S1	Int	INT (EZ)	INC.
40-42	S2	Int	INT (EZ)	INC.
43-59	INC.			
60-69	SK 6 + 🔹			

** = use *Catch+* column to determine receiver

All interceptions on the above table occur in the end zone (EZ) and result in a touchback. The defense takes over on their own 20-yard line.



Replay Review (Optional Rule)



The Disruptor Die also creates the possibility of a play being overturned by review of video replay.

A roll of 7 indicates a “lucky” break for the offense. The offense can improve the call on the field in their favor by means of a replay review.

A roll of 13 is the opposite: an “unlucky” break for the offense where the defense stands to benefit from a replay review.

Procedure

1. On a roll of either 7 or 13, reroll the die to generate a **Bad Call Rating**. A high roll (e.g. 19 or 20) is an egregious call that is likely to be overturned. A low roll is a call that is unlikely to be overturned.

2. Coach chooses whether or not to challenge the ruling on the field. *The following are automatically reviewed and do not require a challenge: touchdowns; safeties; turnovers; plays in the final two minutes of the half.*

3. If the call is challenged/reviewed, roll the 3 result dice and add them together (as you would for a field goal attempt). If this roll is equal to or below the **Bad Call Rating**, the play on the field is overturned.

The impact of the play being overturned depends on the original result of the play:

Offense Wins Challenge (on “Lucky 7”)

Original Result	New Result
Rushing Play	Ball re-spotted Add 1 yard
Incomplete Pass	Completion* (see next column)
Interception or Sack	Incomplete Pass
Fumble	No Fumble Down by Contact ¹
Intentional Grounding ²	No Penalty Incomplete Pass

¹ Runner is down by contact at the spot of the fumble.

² *Intentional Grounding* wasn’t reviewable before 2024.

* Incomplete passes are only ruled complete if the other result on the Play Card is a completed pass.

*Example 1: If a roll of 27 on the Medium Pass card (below) results in an incompletion (INC), a successful challenge by the offense changes it to an 11-yard reception (11**).*

25-27	QB	Accy.	11**	INC.
28-29	QB	Control	INC.	INT 14

Example 2: If a roll of 28 on a Medium Pass (above) yields an incompletion, the offense can’t overturn it.

Defense Wins Challenge (on “Unlucky 13”)

Original Result	New Result
Rushing Play (non-TD)	Ball re-spotted Subtract 1 yard
Rushing Touchdown	Runner didn’t break plane Spot ball at 1-yard line
Complete Pass (no breakaway)	Incomplete Pass
Complete Pass (with breakaway)	Receiver went out of bounds Cut breakaway length in half ³

History of Replay Review

The current system was implemented at the start of the 1999 season:

- Each team is allowed two challenges per game.
- Challenging team must have a timeout remaining.
- If the challenge fails, the team is charged a timeout.

Starting in 2004, coaches are awarded a 3rd challenge if both of their first two challenges succeed.

Starting in 2023, failed 4th-down conversions are automatically reviewed.

Starting in 2024, a team earns a 3rd challenge if *either* of their first two challenges succeeds.

For plays not listed (e.g. kickoffs, punts and field goal attempts) ignore a roll of 7 or 13.

³ Round down fractions (e.g. a “10+B!” result with a 31-yard breakaway changes from 41 yards to a 25-yard gain).

About the Play Cards

Football is complicated. Offenses switch personnel and put players in motion. Defenses juggle responsibilities and work to disguise their schemes. Quarterbacks respond with audibles that change the play at the line.

Season Ticket Football simplifies all of this to a single “play call” by each team. In that context, it makes sense to think of defensive “plays” as areas of focus more than as scripted plays. The pre-snap formation for “short yardage” might look identical to “pass blitz”. It’s what the players do after the snap that can have an effect of the offense’s success.

Offensive Plays

Inside Run: A rushing play between the tackles. Usually the best option in short yardage situations.

Outside Run: A rushing play outside the tackles. Includes pitches and sweeps. Has the potential to gain more yards than Inside Run, but also exposes the runner to being tackled for a loss.

Draw Play: A delayed running play often disguised as a passing play. Best rushing option against the blitz.

Screen Pass: A high-percentage pass caught near the line of scrimmage and advanced down the field. The offensive line’s ability to block downfield on these plays is measured by their “Pass” rating.

Short Pass: A pass caught within 8 yards of the line of scrimmage. Good for short gains and also creates the possibility of a longer breakaway. With time running out, Short Pass is a good option to get the receiver out of bounds quickly to stop the clock.

Medium Pass: Passes thrown 8-15 yards in the air. This is usually the best option in 3rd-and-10, but the Deep Zone and Pass Blitz defenses are effective at reducing its chance of success.

Long Pass: One or more deep pass routes that require the quarterback to throw the ball more than 15 yards in the air. These routes take the most time to develop, increasing the chance that the defense will get pressure on the quarterback.

Defensive Plays

Defensive plays don’t often affect the outcome of the play. When they do, the effect can be significant.

Short Yardage: Linebackers and the strong safety focus on stopping the run between the tackles.

Best Against: Inside Runs

Vulnerable To: Pass Plays

Rush Contain: Linemen and linebackers key on run stopping and “keeping the edge” by containing rushers to the middle of the field.

Best Against: Outside Runs & Draw Plays

Vulnerable To: Medium & Long Passes

Balanced: Default defense. Linebackers provide both pass coverage and additional help stopping the run.

Equally effective (or ineffective) against all play types

Bump & Run: Aggressive press coverage with cornerbacks and linebackers playing underneath to disrupt or intercept screen passes and short passes.

Best Against: Screens & Short Pass

Vulnerable To: Rush Plays & Long Passes

Short Zone: Cornerbacks and linebackers focus their coverage within 10 yards of the line of scrimmage. Lineman focus primarily on providing a pass rush, with safeties usually dropping into deeper coverage.

Best Against: Short Passes

Vulnerable To: Draw Plays

Pass Blitz: The defense sends five or more pass rushers in an attempt to sack the quarterback or force a bad throw. Remaining linebackers and defensive backs focus on pass coverage.

Best Against: Medium & Long Passes

Vulnerable To: Draw Plays & Screen Passes

Deep Zone: Cornerbacks and linebackers drop in coverage, trying to occupy passing lines and keep the play in front of them.

Best Against: Medium & Long Passes

Vulnerable To: Screen Passes & Rushing Plays

The Team Card

Players are grouped by their role, even if their official position doesn't match the position on the Team Card. The 1972 Oilers only had one Tight End. So the **TE2** spot is filled by Hoyle Granger, a blocking fullback with 15 catches out of the backfield.

Similarly, some players are listed at more than one position (e.g. **RB4** and **WR4**). For these players, treat each line as a separate player (i.e. use the ratings on the line referenced by the Play Card or Player Die).

If no player is listed for a position, references to that position fail all rating checks.

Team Stats

The lower right of each Team Card shows stats per-game for the team during the regular season (Rushing, Passing, Rush Defense & Pass Defense). For defensive stats, better rankings (e.g. '1st') indicate lower totals. For example, the 1985 Bears led the league in Rush Defense by allowing only 82.4 rush yards per game.

Player Ratings

Plays in *Season Ticket Football* are decided by comparing a player rating to the blue die. These player ratings are shown in **Blue** on the Team Card (as a reminder that they are always compared to the blue die). If the player rating equals or exceeds the blue die, that player "wins" the *rating check* and achieves the play result preferred by their team.

The blue die ranges from a low of '0' to a high of '9'. This means that a rating of '0' isn't the worst possible rating: a '0' rating will win a rating check if the blue die rolls a '0'. *The worst possible rating is a dash ('-'). This rating always fails a rating check.*

A rating of '4' is defined as "average" because it has exactly a 50% chance of winning a rating check (i.e. half of the rolls on a d10 are 4 or less, and half of the rolls are 5 or higher).

Offensive Player Ratings

Rush: Overall ability to gain yards on the ground.

Power: Rushing between the tackles in short yardage situations.

Rec.: Ability get open and catch passes.

Deep: Throwing/receiving passes of 15+ yards.

Ctrl: Ability to avoid throwing interceptions.

Pass: Blocking downfield on screen passes.

Fum: Tendency to fumble the ball (using the Advanced Rules on page 10). A higher number indicates a higher chance of fumbling.

Defensive Player Ratings

Tackle: Ability to tackle the ball carrier. For defensive lineman and linebackers, this is primarily used to stop running plays. For cornerbacks, this is their ability to tackle receivers after the catch. Safeties use this rating against both run and pass plays.

Sack: Ability to disrupt the passing game by applying pressure and/or sacking the quarterback.

Cover: Preventing completions on pass plays.

Int: Achieving interceptions vs. the passing game.

Strip: Ability to force fumbles.

Solo Play

With one player, you can choose to select the plays for one or both teams, or roll them randomly using the [Play Selection Table](#) tables below:

Roll all 3 result dice. For the offensive play, add the **red** & **white** dice plus one of the following bonuses:

1st & 2nd down: use the relevant bonus from the lower left corner of the Team Card.

3rd & 4th down: use the bonus listed below the Play Selection table matching the yards to go.

For the defensive play, use the **blue** die and *add the same bonus that you added above* (i.e. the defensive play choice reflects the *offense's* tendencies).

Offense: Red d6 + White d10 + Bonus

≤ 5	Inside Run	To Go	Situational
6 - 7	Outside Run	< 10	Short Pass
8	Screen Pass	10 - 19	Medium Pass
9 - 10	Short Pass	20+	Long Pass
11	Draw Play		
12	Long Pass		
13 - 14	Medium Pass		
15+	Situational		

Red Zone

Change Long Pass to Inside Run

Defense: Blue d10 + Bonus

≤ 0	Short Yardage		
1 - 2	Rush Contain		
3 - 4	Balanced		
5	Bump & Run		
6 - 7	Short Zone		
8 - 11	Pass Blitz		
12+	Deep Zone		

Red Zone

Change Deep Zone to Short Zone

Bonus (3rd or 4th down)

To Go	Bonus	To Go	Bonus
1 yard	-3	3-5 yards	+3
2 yards	+0	6+ yards	+6

On offensive rolls of 15 or higher, the situational pass play according to the number of yards to go.

One Roll Resolution

An alternative to the above is to skip the [Play Selection Table](#) and roll directly on the [One Roll Resolution Card](#):

Use two six-sided dice and the white d10 to generate a number from 20-129.

Get the "Play Calling" adjustment from the bottom of the offense's Team Card and multiply it by 5.

Make other adjustments specified on the [One Roll Resolution Card](#) (e.g. for down and distance).

Optional Rules

Interceptions by Defensive Linemen

If the Player Die indicates an interception by a defensive lineman, ignore the distance specified by the play result. Instead, assume the pass was deflected and intercepted near the line of scrimmage:

Roll the white and blue ten-sided dice. Add the white d10 and subtract the blue d10 to determine the distance the pass travels before being intercepted.

(If the blue die is greater than the white die, this will result in a negative number, meaning that the ball is intercepted behind the line of scrimmage.)

Half Sacks

When using the Player Die to determine the defender that is credited with a Sack, roll the die twice and assign a half sack to each player. If both rolls indicate the same player, credit that player with a full sack.

Crediting Forced Fumbles

On fumbles caused by a Strip check, credit that player with a Forced Fumble (FF). For other fumbles, the Fumble Recovery table can also be used to determine who (if anyone) forced a fumble. After determining who recovered the fumble, roll again on the table (using the same modifier if applicable). If the result is a defender, that player forced the fumble. Otherwise, the fumble was unforced.

Safeties on Penalties

By rules, Offensive Holding is a “spot foul” that be assessed from the location of the foul. This is rarely done in the NFL, with the exception of holding that occurs in the end zone. On these occasions, the penalty is assessed in the end zone, resulting in a safety.

On pass plays where Offensive Holding is called, roll the blue d10. If this equals or exceeds the current line of scrimmage, the penalty occurred in the end zone and results in a safety.

Punting From Inside the 3-Yard Line

When punting from inside their own 3-yard line, the punter has less room to receive the snap from center and get off a clean kick.

For punts from the 1-yard line or 2-yard line, add 5 to the punter’s ‘Blk’ rating for any block check.

Assigning Tackles

Assigning the tackler on each play is a bit more complicated than determining the key defender on a sack or interception.

1. On a play with a successful Tackle check, that defender makes the tackle.
2. On a play with a failed Tackle check by a lineman or linebacker, the “backup defender” makes the tackle:

Defender		Backup Defender	Defender		Backup Defender
DL1	→	LB1	LB1	→	CB1
DL2	→	LB2	LB2	→	S1
DL3	→	LB3	LB3	→	CB2
DL4	→	LB4	LB4	→	S2

3. For all other plays, roll a ten-sided die to generate a number from 1 to 10:

- Add 10 if the play went for 6 or more yards.
- Find the total in the defense’s ‘Tackle’ column.

Tackles are awarded even if the ball carrier goes out-of-bounds (see Clock Management on page 9).

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Team Cards

The following Teams are included for free with the game. They may also be altered and shared freely.

2019 Ravens	2019 Chiefs	2019 Patriots
2019 Texans	2019 Bills	2019 Titans
1985 Bears	1985 Rams	1985 Cowboys
1985 Giants	1985 49ers	1985 Patriots

More teams and seasons can be purchased here:

www.seasonticketgames.com

Revision History of this Rulebook

v1.01: Added *Replay Review*. Increased margins.
Expanded *Playing Head-to-Head* (pg. 2).

v1.02: Added *Solo Play* (pg. 2).
Clarifications & formatting.
Fixed two tables to match reference cards.
(*Penalties on FG Attempts; Punt Returns*)
Added *Penalties on Last Play of Half* (pg. 13).

v1.03: Fixed *Kickoff Example* to match team card.

v1.04: Added *Breakaways Under Pressure* (pg. 6).
Added *Penalties on Returns* (pg. 13).

v1.05: Changed “60-69” to “60+” on *Punt Return* table (pg. 7).

v1.06: Clarifications and typos.

v1.07: Tweaked how Disruptor Die is used on sacks
(used as Fumble Check instead of re-rolling).

v1.08: New *Breakaway Table*.
Moved *Solo Play* to page 16.
Added *One Roll Resolution* (pg. 16).
Added *Penalties Near the End Zone* (pg. 12)
Added *Hail Mary Pass* (pg. 12)

v1.10: Revised *Kickoffs Table*.
Revised reference cards:
Offensive Plays & Defensive Plays
One-Roll Resolution

Index

Advanced Rules.....	10	Offensive Player Ratings.....	17
Blocked Kicks.....	10	Offensive Plays (Description)	16
Blocked Punts	10	One Roll Resolution.....	18
Bounces ("Let It Roll")	7	Onside Kicks	4
Breakaways	3	Penalties on Onside Kicks.....	12
Clock Management	9	Optional Rules	19
Defensive Player Ratings.....	17	Overshooting the End Zone	8
Defensive Plays (Description).....	16	Penalties.....	12
Disruptor Die.....	10	Near the End Zone	13
Dynamic Kickoffs	4	on Touchdowns.....	14
Field Goal Attempts	8	Play Results	5
Forced Fumbles.....	19	Player Die	6
Fumble Checks	10	Player Ratings.....	17
Fumble Recovery	6	Punts	7
Game Clock	9	Inside the 3-yard line.....	19
Hail Mary.....	14	Red Zone Offense.....	5
Half Sacks	19	Replay Review	15
Head-to-Head Play	2	Safeties.....	8
Hurry-Up Offense.....	9	on Penalties.....	19
Interception Returns.....	6	Solo Play.....	18
Kickoffs.....	3	Tackles (Assigning)	19
Kickoff Location (by season).....	4		